

ATELIERS

1 SACRED WORKSHOPS

Some of the most exciting conversations in luxury are happening inside ateliers. The knowledge sitting in the hands of specialist makers — tailors, embroiderers, shoemakers, leather-workers, milliners — cannot simply be downloaded or automated. Look at the great London tailoring houses Anderson & Sheppard, Huntsman, and Henry Poole. Beyond the finished suit, their value is in generations of knowledge of the human body, proportion, cloth, and construction. As everything around us becomes faster and more machine-made, the human hand becomes more precious. That, to me, is where real luxury keeps returning.

STYLISTS



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2 BEHIND THE SCENES

The people creating the image around the clothes have become incredibly influential. Law Roach, for example, has helped create the red-carpet identities of major celebrities, while becoming an image-maker in his own right. Elizabeth Stewart, Erin Walsh, and Samantha McMillen are also part of the stylist generation that's shaping how fashion houses are seen globally. That relationship between designer, stylist, celebrity, and audience has changed the way a collection travels. A great garment can now move from a runway in Paris to a red carpet in Los Angeles to millions of screens within hours.

3 MAXIMALIST MAGIC

Quiet luxury has had its moment. Fashion is now ready to have some fun again. Look at Schiaparelli — jewellery-like buttons, sculptural silhouettes, surreal accessories, and clothes designed to be remembered. At Ashi Studio, couture embraces volume, structure, and theatre. In jewellery, designers like Hemmerle render sculptural treatment to their creations, while Fernando Jorge brings movement and sensuality into his pieces. Give me colour, embellishment, jewels, beautiful surfaces, and a little drama. Glamour is wonderful when there's real craftsmanship underneath.

DRAMATIC DESIGN



CRAFT

4 TALKING TECHNIQUES

The most interesting luxury today is often hiding in the making. Look at Loewe, which has turned craft into a central part of its identity through its foundation, its artisanal collaborations, and objects that sit somewhere between fashion and art. Hermès has built an entire universe around leather, silk, and extraordinary specialist craftsmanship. Loro Piana does something similar with textiles — its luxury begins with the fibre and the material itself. That is where I think luxury is heading. The craft is no longer the story behind the product. The craft is the product.

